

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Mahajanapadas: long state-formation transition

JANA -> JANAPADA -> MAHAJANAPADA -> IMPERIAL THRESHOLD

kin community territorial base large competing states Magadhan/Mauryan platform

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c. 1000-600 BCE changes -> c. 6th-4th centuries BCE competitive state system

Sixteen is a conventional list; state formation was neither simultaneous nor linear.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Sixteen Mahajanapadas: political text map

NORTH-WEST: Gandhara, Kamboja | UPPER PLAIN: Kuru, Panchala, Matsya, Surasena

CENTRAL/WEST: Chedi, Avanti, Vatsa | TRANS-VINDHYAN: Assaka

MIDDLE/EAST GANGA: Kashi, Kosala, Anga, Magadha

REPUBLICAN EAST: Vajji, Malla | textual lists and placements can vary

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FOUR LEADING MONARCHIES: Magadha, Kosala, Vatsa, Avanti

Map polity to capital, route and rivalry; do not draw fixed modern borders.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Monarchy and gana-sangha compared

MONARCHY	GANA-SANGHA
hereditary/dynastic rajan	assembly of chiefly lineages
court, officials, organised force	deliberation among oligarchic elites
expanding taxation/territory	corporate sovereignty/confederacy
village heads link centre/local	non-elite, women and dependants excluded
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Two state forms: gana was not modern democracy; monarchy was not automatic progress.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Second urbanisation: city-system mechanism

agricultural surplus + extraction + crafts + routes + merchant finance

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Rajagriha | Kaushambi | Vaishali | Champa | later Pataliputra

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NBPW horizon + craft quarters + markets + punch-marked coin circulation

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Urbanisation was networked and uneven; NBPW and coins are indicators, not sole causes.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Agrarian political economy and social change

forest clearance/fields + iron in context + cattle/plough labour

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surplus -> tax/share -> army/officials/forts -> market and town demand

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gahapati household elites

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setthi, merchants and craft groups

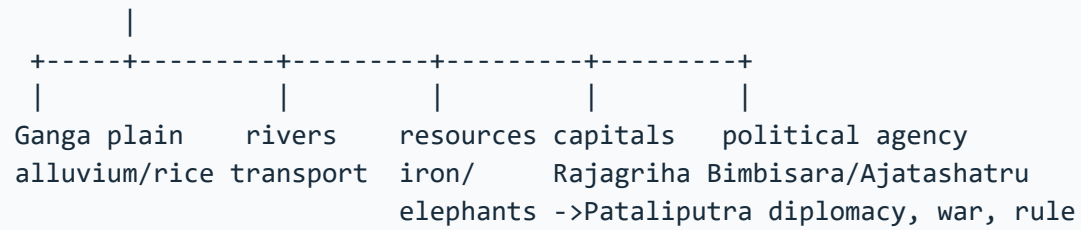
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Varna claims, new wealth and shramana critiques intersect in urbanising society.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Why Magadha? interacting causal matrix

MAGADHAN ASCENDANCY

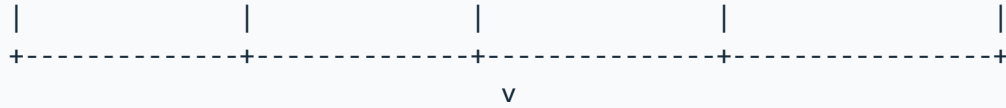


Advantages became power through institutions; no geography or resource monopoly alone.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Magadhan dynastic expansion sequence

BIMBISARA -> AJATASHATRU -> UDAYIN -> SHISHUNAGA -> NANDAS -> MAURYAN THRESHOLD

Anga, marriage Kosala/Vajji wars Pataliputra Avanti absorbed resources/army

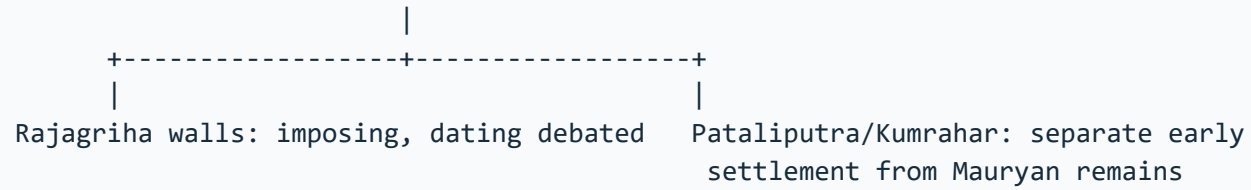


Expansion combined conquest, diplomacy, capital relocation and accumulation.

Traditions disagree on exact succession; use the sequence without false precision.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Archaeology and source limits of early Magadha

SOURCES: Buddhist/Jaina traditions + Puranic lists + archaeology + later reports



VERDICT: texts preserve political memory; archaeology tests place and phase, not episode.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: From competitive states to empire

MAHAJANAPADA COMPETITION

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larger armies + taxation + capitals + routes + diplomatic repertoires

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Magadhan absorption of Anga, Vajji, Kosala links and Avanti rivalry

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Nanda-scale accumulation -> institutional and territorial platform for Mauryas
Legacy is capacity-building, not destiny; rivals once had viable alternatives.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Mahajanapada-Magadha answer architecture

10 MARKS: define transition -> map 3 polities -> institution/economy -> caution

15 MARKS: state forms -> second urbanisation -> Magadha matrix -> dynasty sequence

20 MARKS: chronology/list/map -> monarchy/gana -> agrarian-urban economy

-> Magadha matrix -> Haryanka-Nanda agency -> source limits -> empire bridge

AVOID: fixed borders, gana = democracy, iron/geography as single cause.

CLOSE: Magadha converted opportunity into durable power through strategy and institutions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. = from source book = inference / standard knowledge = current affairs.
2. # Claim Named evidence Significance Limitation
3. Year Paper Q PYQ demand (neutral rendering) Directive / format Source...

VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Source layer Topic 11 use Non-negotiable limit
2. Contested issues Competing interpretations are attributed, evidenced...
3. Inscription and coin evidence: contemporary names, titles, claims and...

VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.